

SHREYAS MEHER

Postdoctoral Researcher, Erasmus University Rotterdam

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EMPLOYMENT

Erasmus University Rotterdam

June 2025 – present

Postdoctoral Researcher, Erasmus School of Social and Behavioural Sciences

TWIN4DEM project (Horizon Europe): digital twins of executive aggrandizement in parliamentary democracies

The University of Texas at Dallas

August 2023 – May 2025

Graduate Research Assistant, NSF project *Frameworks: Infrastructure for Political and Social Event Data Using Machine Learning*

The University of Texas at Dallas

August 2020 – July 2023

Teaching Assistant, School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Public Policy and Political Economy

2025

The University of Texas at Dallas

Dissertation: *Digital Sovereignty: The Political Economy of Internet Governance*

Committee: Clint Peinhardt (Chair), Pengfei Zhang (Co-Chair), Patrick T. Brandt

M.S., Management

2020

The University of Texas at Dallas

M.S., Public Policy

2018

St. Xavier's College, Mumbai

B.S., Economics

2016

Sarla Anil Modi School of Economics, NMIMS, Mumbai

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Digital governance and internet censorship, democratic backsliding and executive aggrandizement, political conflict, computational social science and large language models

PUBLICATIONS

Brandt, P. T., Alsarra, S., D'Orazio, V., Heintze, D., Khan, L., **Meher, S.**, Osorio, J., & Sianan, M. (2025). Extractive versus generative language models for political conflict text classification. *Political Analysis*, 1–29. [doi:10.1017/pan.2025.10027](https://doi.org/10.1017/pan.2025.10027)

Meher, S., & Brandt, P. T. (2025). ConflLlama: Domain-specific adaptation of large language models for conflict event classification. *Research & Politics*, 12(3). [doi:10.1177/20531680251356282](https://doi.org/10.1177/20531680251356282)

Kumar, S., **Meher, S.**, & Zhang, P. (2025). Public health advocacy in times of pandemic: An analysis of the Medicare-For-All debate on Twitter during COVID-19. *Behavioral Sciences*, 15(2),

223. [doi:10.3390/bs15020223](https://doi.org/10.3390/bs15020223)

Egger, C., Meher, S., & Zhelyazkova, A. Framework Laws and Fading Oversight: How the Dutch Executive Expanded Its Lawmaking Authority. *International Political Science Review*. *Revise & resubmit*

UNDER REVIEW

Electoral Accountability and the Channeling of Content Removal: Theory and Evidence from Google Transparency Reports (with Pengfei Zhang)

Two Types of Censorship? An Assessment of the Informational Autocracy Thesis (with Pengfei Zhang)

Selective Scrutiny: Single-Party Majority and the Strategic Withdrawal of Parliamentary Oversight in India

Build, Borrow, or Just Fine-Tune? Empirical Guidelines for NLP Model Selection in Computational Social Science

“Why Aren’t We Talking About This?” The Attention Trap in Networked Protest

Silencing the Silencing: Media Amplification of Internet Shutdowns in India

WORKING PAPERS

Building Capacity or Building Checks? What EU Enlargement Reports Emphasise and Democratic Backsliding (with Asya Zhelyazkova & Clara Egger)

Strategic Anticipation and Expert Review: The Determinants of Critical Advisory Opinions from the Dutch Council of State (with Clara Egger & Asya Zhelyazkova)

On Time, but Empty: How Dutch Ministers Answer Their Critics

Between the Documents: Unit Choice in Corpus-Scale Political Text Analysis

Using Messy Text in Future LLM Annotations (with Patrick T. Brandt, Paula Cuellar-Cuellar & Xingyuan Zhao)

Event Horizon: Revolutionizing Data Annotation with Reinforcement Learning

GRANTS & FUNDED RESEARCH

TWIN4DEM: Strengthening Democratic Resilience Through Digital Twins 2025 – 2027

Horizon Europe. Postdoctoral Researcher; PIs: Clara Egger & Asya Zhelyazkova

Frameworks: Infrastructure for Political and Social Event Data 2023 – 2026

National Science Foundation. Graduate Research Assistant; PI: Patrick T. Brandt

SOFTWARE

Conflibert GUI — Browser-based NLP toolkit for conflict and political violence text analysis: named entity recognition, classification, question answering, and LoRA/QLoRA fine-tuning.

conflibertR — R package wrapping Conflibert for inference, fine-tuning, benchmarking, and model comparison.

TEACHING

Instructor, Global Development Issues 2025 – 2026

Erasmus University Rotterdam. Quantitative research design for policy evaluation, causal inference, and panel data estimation, with R programming labs.

Supervisor, MISOC Bachelor Project 2025 – 2026

Erasmus University Rotterdam. Digital governance, platform labour, and power in the digital economy.

Instructor, EPPS Math & Coding Camp August 2024

The University of Texas at Dallas. Five-day intensive for incoming Ph.D. students: R programming, data manipulation, visualization, and linear regression.

Teaching Assistant, The University of Texas at Dallas 2020 – 2023

Research Design (EPPS 2301); Class, Status, and Power (SOC 4302); Political Economy of Industrialized Countries (IPEC 4301); Government and Politics of Afghanistan (PSCI 4396); Applied Regression (EPPS 6316); Political Violence and Conflict in Cyberspace (PPPE/PSCI 6302); Introduction to Quantitative Methods (EPPS 6313); Foreign Aid and Development (IPEC/PSCI 4318)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC ² S ²)	2025
American Political Science Association (APSA)	2024, 2025
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	2024, 2025, 2026
European Political Science Society (EPSS)	2026
International Studies Association (ISA)	2025
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)	2024
Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics (SIOE)	2024
UTD PPPE Working Paper Series	2023

HONORS & AWARDS

CAFÉ Research Scholar 2020

The Colloquium for the Advancement of Free-Enterprise Education, UT Dallas

Dean's Excellence Scholarship 2020

The University of Texas at Dallas

SERVICE & OTHER

Peer reviewer: *Political Behavior*

Book contribution: *American Government & State and Local Government*, Cognella Publishing (2021)

SKILLS

R, Python, Stata, L^AT_EX, ArcGIS, C++

REFERENCES

Patrick T. Brandt

Professor of Public Policy, Political Economy,
and Political Science
The University of Texas at Dallas
pbrandt@utdallas.edu

Pengfei Zhang

Assistant Professor of Public Policy and Political Economy
The University of Texas at Dallas
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and Political Economy
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